MODULE 29 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

What Changed Since the Guide

Every product and policy change since the July 2026 exam guide, dated, with the exam-safe answer for each.

DOMAIN All EXAM WEIGHT Currency MODULE 29 of 33

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Answer by what a feature is for, not by where the button is.

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The timeline, July and August 2026

DATE	CHANGE
30 June	Exam delivery moves to Pearson VUE; credentials through Credly
July	Exam guide version 1.0 published
10 July	Memory becomes individual, categorised entries
24 July	Claude Opus 5 released
25 August	Memory works across chat and Cowork; editable topics; sensitive topics setting; off by default on Team and Enterprise

THE SIGNAL

Memory changed twice in six weeks. The purpose of Memory did not change at all.

The timeline, September to November 2026

DATE	CHANGE
1 September	Claude Fable 5.1 above Opus; Mythos 5.1 for restricted research use
16 September	The new Claude experience: Cowork merged into every conversation; Docs, Slides and Design templates
22 and 28 September	Claude Opus 5.5, then Sonnet 5.5
7 October	Claude Haiku 5.5
8 October to 12 November	Usage Policy update posted; takes effect on 12 November

THE SIGNAL

Five model releases in four months. The exam still tests three tiers.

Change, then the exam-safe answer

WHAT CHANGED	EXAM-SAFE ANSWER
No separate chat and Cowork modes	Answer by purpose: one-off, persistent, or multi-step
No web search toggle	"Web search" still means a quick current fact
Artifact templates	An artifact is still content to keep or share
Memory as editable topics	Memory is still personal; team knowledge is a Project
New model names	Haiku fast and light, Sonnet balanced, Opus most capable
Usage Policy rewrite	High-risk safeguards unchanged

ON THE EXAM

Every change moved a button. None changed what the right choice is for.

The new Claude experience

- **16 September 2026:** Cowork features rolled into every conversation; no mode to choose.
- **Carried over:** chats, tasks, Projects, connectors and Skills.
- **Rolling out gradually:** Pro and Max first; Free and Team after; Enterprise with notice.
- **No web search toggle:** Claude searches when it helps; Research still runs longer, cited investigations.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> If an option says "chat" or "research mode", read it as the purpose it names.

Artifacts and Memory, now

- **Artifacts:** Docs, Slides and Design in any conversation, on all plans; Enterprise admins enable them.
- **Exports:** documents to Word, PDF or Google Docs; decks to PowerPoint, PDF or Google Slides.
- **Memory:** editable topics; say "remember this"; sensitive topics excluded by default.
- **New detail:** deleting a chat no longer deletes the memories it created. Edit the topic instead.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Inline to read once, artifact to keep or share, structured data for a system. Unchanged.

The Usage Policy update

- **Posted 8 October; in force 12 November 2026.**
- **High-risk section rewritten for clarity:** health, legal rights, finances, livelihood, essential services.
- **Requirements unchanged:** a qualified human with authority to change the output; affected people told AI was used.
- **New:** equipment that takes autonomous physical actions needs an operator who can observe and stop it.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Anthropic says the high-risk requirements "haven't changed". Neither does your answer.

Exam logistics, current

- **Delivery:** Pearson VUE, online proctored or at a test centre, in English.
- **Format:** 60 items in 120 minutes; pass mark scaled 720; each item says how many to choose.
- **Eligibility:** Claude Partner Network organisations only, with a company email address.
- **Credentials** through Credly. Check the exam page before you book; details can change.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> The exam itself has not changed since the guide. Book through the official route only.

When the screen and the guide disagree

IF AN OPTION SAYS...	READ IT AS...
"Turn on web search"	Use a quick search for a current fact
"Use research mode"	Run a cited, multi-source investigation
"Create an artifact"	Produce content to keep or share
"Use Opus" or "use Haiku"	Pick the tier the task needs
"Switch to Cowork"	Run a multi-step task in Claude

ON THE EXAM

Translate the label into its purpose, then answer the question the exam is really asking.

Currency traps

THE TRAP	WHY IT FAILS
Rejecting an option because the button moved	The purpose is still right
Choosing the newest model by name	The exam tests tiers
Assuming the policy update changed safeguards	The requirements are unchanged
Deleting chats to remove a memory	No longer works; edit the topic
Trusting a remembered figure about plans or limits	They change monthly; check the current page

ON THE EXAM

Every trap answers the screen, not the question.

> A Halden colleague is practising for the exam. A question asks how to get today's euro exchange rate for a supplier invoice.
>
> She hesitates over option A, because her screen no longer has a web search toggle.

Which option should she choose?

A. Use web search to find today's published rate

B. Run a multi-source research investigation

C. Ask Claude to state the rate from its own knowledge

D. Create a Project for exchange rates

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which option should she choose?

A Use web search to find today's published rate

One current fact: a quick search, whatever the button.

B Run a multi-source research investigation

Minutes of investigation for one figure.

C Ask Claude to state the rate from its own knowledge

Knowledge has a cutoff; rates move daily.

D Create a Project for exchange rates

Nothing needs to persist.

THE SIGNAL

The button moved; the purpose did not. One current fact means a quick search.

> A practice question asks which model suits drafting two thousand short, simple replies a day. The options are Haiku, Sonnet and Opus, with no version numbers.
>
> A candidate worries that Fable is missing from the list.

How should he answer?

A Assume the intended answer is Fable, since it is the most capable

B Apply tier logic: Haiku for high-volume, simple, fast work

C Choose Sonnet, because it is the newest tier

D Skip the question, since the line-up is out of date

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should he answer?

A Assume the intended answer is Fable, since it is the most capable

Not an option, and the wrong tier for the task.

B Apply tier logic: Haiku for high-volume, simple, fast work

Tier logic: volume and speed means Haiku.

C Choose Sonnet, because it is the newest tier

Newness is not the deciding detail.

D Skip the question, since the line-up is out of date

The tier logic still answers it.

THE SIGNAL

The exam tests tiers, not release names.

> Halden's Claude champion is updating the internal training notes after the September changes.

Which two statements are still true after the September changes? Choose two.

A An artifact is for substantial content to keep or share

B You must switch on a research toggle to look up a single current fact

C Memory is personal, and team knowledge belongs in a Project

D Memory can only be removed all at once

E Cowork is a separate product with its own separate chats

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two statements are still true after the September changes? Choose two.

A An artifact is for substantial content to keep or share

Still the purpose of an artifact.

B You must switch on a research toggle to look up a single current fact

No toggle now; and a single fact never needed Research.

C Memory is personal, and team knowledge belongs in a Project

Still the split between Memory and Projects.

D Memory can only be removed all at once

Topics can be edited or deleted one by one.

E Cowork is a separate product with its own separate chats

Cowork merged into every conversation.

THE SIGNAL

Purposes survived the changes. Buttons and modes did not.

> Halden's HR director asks whether the Usage Policy update taking effect on 12 November means the performance-review design must change.
>
> The design has managers decide every rating with authority to change anything, and staff are told AI assisted.

What is the accurate answer?

A Yes: AI can no longer be used anywhere in employment decisions

B Yes: human review is no longer required after the update

C No: the high-risk requirements are unchanged, so keep the design and re-read the final text

D No: the policy does not apply to Team plan customers

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the accurate answer?

A Yes: AI can no longer be used anywhere in employment decisions

High-risk use is allowed with safeguards.

B Yes: human review is no longer required after the update

Review is still required.

C No: the high-risk requirements are unchanged, so keep the design and re-read the final text

Safeguards unchanged; the design already meets them.

D No: the policy does not apply to Team plan customers

The policy applies to all users.

THE SIGNAL

The high-risk requirements did not change, and the design already meets them.

> A Halden manager deleted the chats where she once mentioned her old job title, but Claude still refers to it.
>
> The rest of what Claude remembers is useful.

What should she do?

A. Open her Memory settings and edit or delete the out-of-date topic

B. Reset Memory entirely

C. Delete every chat where she mentioned her old role

D. Use incognito for all future chats

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should she do?

A Open her Memory settings and edit or delete the out-of-date topic

Memory is topics now: fix the one topic.

B Reset Memory entirely

Deletes the useful memories too.

C Delete every chat where she mentioned her old role

No longer removes the memory it created.

D Use incognito for all future chats

Gives up Memory to avoid one stale fact.

THE SIGNAL

Deleting chats no longer removes memories. Edit the topic.

> Halden is a member of the Claude Partner Network. Its Claude champion wants to book the Claude Certified Associate exam.

What is the right way to book?

A Register with a personal email address and book at any test centre

B Use her Halden company email, check the current exam page, and book through Pearson VUE, online or at a test centre

C Ask in a Claude chat to book the exam for her

D Book directly through Credly

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the right way to book?

A Register with a personal email address and book at any test centre

Personal addresses are rejected.

B Use her Halden company email, check the current exam page, and book through Pearson VUE, online or at a test centre

Partner email, current page, Pearson VUE.

C Ask in a Claude chat to book the exam for her

Not a booking route.

D Book directly through Credly

Credly issues credentials; it does not deliver exams.

THE SIGNAL

Company email, the current exam page, then Pearson VUE.

In five lines

- **Answer by purpose,** not by where the button is.
- **September 2026:** one Claude experience, no web search toggle, Docs, Slides and Design templates.
- **Memory:** editable topics; deleting a chat no longer deletes its memories.
- **Models:** 5.5 family and Fable above Opus; the exam still tests three tiers.
- **Usage Policy:** rewritten, in force 12 November; high-risk safeguards unchanged.

COMING UP

Next: how the exam's questions are written, and how to read them.